How to Land a UK Visa-Sponsored Role

Your step-by-step guide to finding,

applying and getting sponsored in the UK

FREE GUIDE BY MENTORGRAM AI

mentorgramai.com

About This Guide

Getting a visa-sponsored job in the UK is one of the most valuable career moves an international professional can make. But the process is confusing — most candidates don't know where to look, how to identify genuine sponsors, or what employers actually want to see.

This guide cuts through the noise. It gives you a practical, step-by-step roadmap — from understanding how UK visa sponsorship works, to finding the right jobs, writing applications that get noticed, and preparing for the interview.

- ❖ Who this guide is for: International professionals seeking employment in the UK
- ❖ Countries covered: UK, Australia, Germany, Finland, Austria
- ❖ Time to read: ~15 minutes
- ❖ Created by: Mentorgram AI — mentorgramai.com

What You'll Learn

→ How the UK Skilled Worker visa and sponsorship system actually works

→ How to identify legitimate visa-sponsoring employers

→ Where to find sponsored job listings (including free tools)

→ How to tailor your CV and cover letter to stand out

→ What to expect in the application and visa process

→ The 5 most common mistakes applicants make — and how to avoid them

Chapter 1: How UK Visa Sponsorship Works

Before you start applying, you need to understand the system. Many candidates waste months applying to companies that cannot legally hire them. Here's how it works.

The Skilled Worker Visa

The UK Skilled Worker visa replaced the old Tier 2 (General) visa in 2021. To qualify, you need:

- A job offer from a UK employer with a valid Sponsor Licence
- The role must be at RQF Level 3 or above (roughly A-Level equivalent)
- A salary meeting the minimum threshold (currently £26,200/yr or the 'going rate' for the role, whichever is higher)
- English language proficiency (B1 CEFR level or above)
- You must score 70 points under the points-based system

What Is a Sponsor Licence?

Employers must hold a Home Office-approved Sponsor Licence to hire overseas workers. Not every company has one — only around 60,000 UK employers are registered. This is why filtering your job search to licensed sponsors saves enormous time.

> ■ KEY INSIGHT: Always check the GOV.UK Register of Licensed Sponsors before spending time on an application.
>
> Search at: gov.uk/government/publications/register-of-licensed-sponsors-workers
>
> Or use Mentorgram's Visa Sponsors page to search the database instantly: mentorgramai.com#visa-sponsors

The Certificate of Sponsorship (CoS)

Once an employer offers you a role, they assign you a Certificate of Sponsorship (CoS) — a unique reference number you include in your visa application. This is the employer's formal commitment to sponsor you. You then apply for your visa using this reference.

Chapter 2: Where to Find Sponsored Jobs

Finding genuinely sponsored roles requires a targeted approach. Generic job boards are full of listings that don't offer sponsorship. Here's where to look.

Best Sources for Sponsored Roles

Mentorgram AI — *mentorgramai.com#jobs*

Free — aggregates sponsored jobs from Indeed, Reed, Adzuna and jobs.ac.uk. Filter specifically for 'Visa Sponsorship'. Also search our licensed sponsors database.

GOV.UK Sponsor Register — *gov.uk*

The definitive list of 60,000+ licensed UK sponsors. Download the Excel file and filter by sector to find companies in your field.

Indeed UK — *indeed.co.uk*

Search '[job title] visa sponsorship' or '[job title] skilled worker'. Many listings explicitly state sponsorship availability.

Reed.co.uk — *reed.co.uk*

Strong for healthcare, finance and public sector. Use keywords like 'certificate of sponsorship' or 'tier 2 sponsorship'.

LinkedIn — *linkedin.com/jobs*

Many UK employers post roles with visa sponsorship noted in the description. Set job alerts with 'sponsorship' keyword.

NHS Jobs — *jobs.nhs.uk*

The NHS is one of the UK's largest visa sponsors. Thousands of healthcare roles available with sponsorship.

jobs.ac.uk — *jobs.ac.uk*

UK universities and research institutes. Academic and research roles frequently offer sponsorship for international talent.

■ PRO TIP: Download the GOV.UK Sponsor Register spreadsheet, filter by your sector (SIC code),

and create a target list of 50 employers. Then search their careers pages directly.

This approach bypasses the competition on public job boards.

Chapter 3: Writing a Sponsored-Role Application

Your CV for UK Employers

UK CVs have specific conventions. International candidates often make avoidable mistakes:

✓ Length: 2 pages maximum. No photo, no date of birth, no nationality on the CV itself

✓ Format: Reverse chronological — most recent role first

✓ Skills section: Include specific tools, software and certifications relevant to the role

✓ Achievements: Use numbers — '£2M budget managed', 'team of 8', '30% efficiency improvement'

✓ Visa status: Add a line: 'Requires Skilled Worker Visa Sponsorship' — be upfront, don't hide it

Cover Letter Formula

Your cover letter should follow this structure:

1 Opening Hook

Name the role. State your headline qualification. In one sentence, say why you want this specific company.

2 Skills Match

Pick 3 requirements from the job description. Provide a specific example of how you've demonstrated each one.

3 Address Sponsorship

Be direct: 'I am available to start upon obtaining a Skilled Worker Visa. I am aware that [Company] holds a Sponsor Licence and am prepared to complete all required documentation promptly.'

4 Closing

Express enthusiasm. Invite them to interview. Keep it to 3-4 lines.

Addressing Sponsorship Directly

Many candidates are afraid to mention they need sponsorship. Don't be. If a company is registered as a sponsor, they have already committed to hiring overseas workers. Being upfront saves everyone's time and shows professionalism.

■ TEMPLATE PHRASE: 'I hold [degree/qualification] from [institution] and have [X years] experience in [field].

I am an international professional requiring a Skilled Worker Visa. I confirm I meet the salary

threshold and am ready to begin the visa application process immediately upon receiving an offer.'

Chapter 4: The Interview & Visa Process

Interview Preparation

UK employers hiring international candidates want to see:

→ Technical competence — be ready for role-specific assessments or case studies

→ Cultural fit — research the company's values and reference them

→ Clarity about your visa situation — be prepared to explain the timeline

→ Long-term commitment — employers want to know you plan to stay

Questions to Ask Your Employer

Asking the right questions shows professionalism:

- 'Does your company currently hold an active Sponsor Licence?'
- 'What is your typical timeline for processing a CoS once an offer is made?'
- 'Have you sponsored overseas workers before? Can you share the experience?'
- 'What support does the company provide during the visa application process?'

The Visa Process Timeline

Stage	Typical Duration	What Happens
Job offer received	Day 0	Employer confirms they will sponsor
CoS assigned	1–4 weeks	Employer requests CoS from Home Office
Visa application	1–3 weeks	You submit online application + documents
Decision (standard)	3–8 weeks	Home Office processes application
Decision (priority)	5 working days	Priority service available at extra cost
Start date	After visa granted	You can begin work

Chapter 5: 5 Costly Mistakes to Avoid

× 1

Applying to non-sponsors

Always verify the company is on the GOV.UK Sponsor Register before applying. Thousands of job listings don't offer sponsorship but don't state this clearly. Don't waste your time.

× 2

Hiding your visa requirements

Some candidates don't mention needing sponsorship until after an offer. This wastes everyone's time and damages trust. Be upfront in your cover letter.

× 3

Generic CVs

Sending the same CV to every employer rarely works. Tailor each application to mirror the language in the job description. Use their exact keywords.

× 4

Ignoring salary thresholds

If the advertised salary is below £26,200 (or the role's 'going rate'), you likely won't qualify for a Skilled Worker Visa. Check before applying.

× 5

Not researching the company

UK employers expect candidates to know the company. Research their recent news, products, values and competitors. Reference this in your interview.

Your Next Steps

You now have everything you need to start your UK job search with confidence. Here's your action plan:

Step 1: Check the GOV.UK Sponsor Register for employers in your sector

Step 2: Update your CV to UK format — 2 pages, no photo, achievements with numbers

Step 3: Search mentorgramai.com/jobs — filter by 'Visa Sponsorship'

Step 4: Create a target list of 30–50 licensed sponsors to approach directly

Step 5: Tailor each application — CV + cover letter — to the specific role

Step 6: In your cover letter, mention sponsorship directly and professionally

Step 7: Prepare for interviews: technical competence + cultural fit + visa clarity

■ Find UK Visa-Sponsored Jobs Now

mentorgramai.com/jobs

Free job search · 500+ sponsoring employers · Updated daily

Questions? Email us at **info@mentorgramai.com** or find us on Instagram **@mentorgramai**

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